

Fixed Deposit – Frequently Asked Questions

A reference guide for common depositor queries

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Fixed Deposit Servicing Knowledge Base

This document answers the questions most frequently raised by depositors regarding Fixed Deposit (FD) accounts. It is intended for use by customer service teams and self-service support tools when responding to depositor queries.

1. Booking & Eligibility

Who can open a Fixed Deposit?

Resident individuals, joint holders, minors (through a guardian), HUFs, trusts, and registered companies can open a Fixed Deposit, subject to submission of valid KYC documents.

What is the minimum and maximum deposit amount?

The minimum deposit amount is Rs 5,000. There is no upper limit on the deposit amount, though deposits above Rs 2 crore are treated as bulk deposits and may carry a different rate card.

What tenure options are available?

Tenures range from 12 months to 60 months. Within this range, depositors can choose any tenure in completed months; interest rates vary by tenure slab (see the Product Guide for the current rate card).

What documents are required to open an FD?

- PAN card (mandatory for deposits above Rs 50,000 or where TDS is applicable)
- Address proof (Aadhaar, passport, voter ID, or utility bill)
- A recent passport-size photograph
- Bank account details for interest/maturity payout
- Form 15G/15H, if applicable, to avoid TDS deduction

2. Interest & Payout

How is interest paid out?

Depositors can choose a cumulative option, where interest is compounded and paid at maturity along with the principal, or a non-cumulative option, where interest is paid out monthly, quarterly, half-yearly, or annually as selected at the time of booking.

When is the periodic interest credited?

Periodic interest is credited to the registered bank account within 3 working days of the due date (e.g., quarterly payouts are credited within 3 working days of each quarter-end from the deposit start date, not the calendar quarter).

My periodic interest has not been credited. What should I do?

Depositors should first confirm that the registered bank account is active and that KYC is up to date, as either issue can hold up a payout. If the due date has passed by more than 3 working days, the query should be logged as a payout-delay request quoting the FD account number; see the SOP document for the resolution process and timelines.

Can I change the payout frequency after booking?

Payout frequency cannot be changed mid-tenure. A depositor who wants a different frequency must wait until maturity and book a new FD with the desired option, or close the existing FD prematurely (penalty terms apply).

3. Maturity & Renewal

What happens when my FD matures?

Three working days before the maturity date, a reminder is sent to the depositor's registered email and mobile number. On the maturity date, the depositor can choose to withdraw the full amount, renew the deposit (same or different tenure), or split the amount between withdrawal and renewal.

What if I do not respond before the maturity date?

If no instruction is received, the deposit is auto-renewed for the same tenure at the interest rate applicable on the maturity date, unless the depositor opted out of auto-renewal at the time of booking.

Can I stop auto-renewal after it has already happened?

Yes. The depositor can request a reversal within 7 calendar days of the auto-renewal date. Interest already accrued under the renewed terms will be recalculated as a normal premature closure of the renewed deposit.

How do I change the bank account for receiving my maturity amount?

A bank account change request can be submitted with a cancelled cheque or bank statement of the new account, at least 5 working days before maturity. Requests received after this window may still be processed but could delay the payout beyond the maturity date.

4. Premature Withdrawal

Can I withdraw my FD before maturity?

Yes, premature withdrawal is permitted after a minimum lock-in of 3 months from the deposit start date, except for tax-saving FDs, which carry a mandatory 5-year lock-in with no premature withdrawal option except in the case of the depositor's death.

What penalty applies on premature withdrawal?

Tenure completed	Penalty on applicable rate
3 months to less than 6 months	1.50%
6 months to less than 12 months	1.00%
12 months and above	0.50% to 1.00%, depending on the rate card in force at the time of booking

Note: The penalty is applied to the interest rate that was actually payable for the period the deposit was held, not the rate originally booked for the full tenure.

How long does it take to receive the premature withdrawal amount?

Once the request is approved, funds are credited to the registered bank account within 2 to 3 working days.

5. Tax & TDS

Is interest on my FD taxable?

Yes. Interest earned on a Fixed Deposit is fully taxable as "Income from Other Sources" under the applicable tax laws and must be declared in the depositor's income tax return, regardless of whether TDS was deducted.

When is TDS deducted?

TDS is deducted if the total interest earned across all deposits with the Company in a financial year exceeds Rs 40,000 for individuals below 60 years, or Rs 50,000 for senior citizens. TDS is deducted at the time interest is credited or paid, whichever is earlier.

How can I avoid TDS deduction?

Depositors whose total income is below the taxable limit can submit Form 15G (or Form 15H for senior citizens) at the start of every financial year to avoid TDS deduction.

Where can I get my TDS certificate?

Form 16A, certifying the TDS deducted in a financial year, is issued quarterly and can be downloaded from the depositor portal after the due date for TDS return filing for that quarter. It can also be requested through customer service, quoting the FD account number and the financial year.

6. Senior Citizen Benefits

What additional benefit do senior citizens get?

Depositors aged 60 years and above are eligible for an additional rate benefit (commonly 0.25% to 0.50% over the standard rate, depending on the tenure slab in force) and a higher TDS threshold.

What proof of age is required?

A valid age proof such as PAN, Aadhaar, passport, or senior citizen card must be submitted at the time of booking to avail the senior citizen rate.

Can a deposit be booked on behalf of a senior citizen family member?

Yes, provided the deposit is booked in the senior citizen's own name (held singly or as the first/primary holder in a joint account) with their KYC and age proof submitted.

7. Servicing & Account Changes

How do I get a statement or duplicate FD receipt?

Statements and duplicate receipts can be downloaded from the depositor portal or requested through customer service. A request submitted by email is typically processed within 2 working days.

My KYC details have changed. What should I update?

Any change in address, mobile number, email, or bank account should be updated promptly by submitting the relevant proof. Updates to mobile number and email take effect within 1 working day; address and bank account changes may take up to 5 working days as they require document verification.

What happens to the FD if the depositor passes away before maturity?

The nominee or legal heir can claim the deposit by submitting a death certificate, the original FD receipt, identity and relationship proof, and a claim form. The deposit can either be paid out or transferred to the nominee's name, depending on their preference. See the SOP document for the detailed claim process.